

# Anthropic Fellows Optional Research Proposal

## Empirical Evaluation of AI Agents in Small-Business and Community-Organization Workflows

Prepared by Alfred Colvin | Optional add-on for Anthropic Fellows Economics & Policy

### Research Question

How do AI agents affect productivity, decision quality, and operational risk in small businesses, churches, nonprofits, and community organizations?

### Motivation

Small organizations are often early adopters of practical AI tools, but they usually lack formal evaluation, compliance support, technical staff, or safety review processes. This creates an important research opportunity: AI may increase productivity and access to expertise, but it may also introduce misinformation, overreliance, poor customer communication, or compliance risk.

### Proposed Method

Create a benchmark of common workflows such as lead follow-up, grant readiness, marketing campaigns, client communication, research summarization, and internal task routing. Compare human-only, AI-drafted, and AI-plus-human-review workflows. Measure time saved, output quality, accuracy, risk flags, human-review burden, and deployment readiness.

### Expected Output

A public research report or paper-style writeup showing where AI agents create measurable value for small organizations, where human review remains essential, and what evaluation practices reduce operational risk.

### Fit With Anthropic

This research connects AI economics, labor productivity, access to capability, organizational resilience, and safe deployment. It is grounded in real-world workflows and focuses on practical methods for understanding both the upside and risk of AI adoption.